POLICY 04 / 06

Equality and Diversity Policy

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POLICY OWNER	Spook Directors
APPROVED BY	Martin Luck
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Spook Limited | Registration number 04630774

“Spook” means Spook Limited. “Directors” means the two Spook founding directors: Martin Luck and Andrew des’ Ascoyne.

Each policy will be reviewed annually and sooner where changes in legislation, business activities or identified risks require it.

01 Purpose

Spook is committed to a working environment in which people are treated fairly, with dignity and respect, and have equitable access to opportunities.

Spook will prevent unlawful discrimination, harassment and victimisation and take practical steps to support inclusion.

02 Scope

This policy applies to recruitment, employment, training, promotion, pay, working arrangements, conduct, service delivery and the ending of employment or engagement.

It covers directors, employees and workers, and relevant conduct by contractors, customers, suppliers and other third parties. It applies at work, during remote working, through digital communications and at work-related events.

03 Responsibilities

Directors are accountable for implementing this policy and ensuring complaints are addressed fairly.

Spook must use objective criteria in decisions, respond to concerns promptly and consider reasonable adjustments.

Everyone must treat others respectfully, avoid discriminatory conduct and cooperate with measures to prevent and address inappropriate behaviour.

04 Equal treatment

Spook prohibits unlawful discrimination connected with age, disability, gender reassignment, marriage and civil partnership, pregnancy and maternity, race, religion or belief, sex, or sexual orientation.

This includes direct and indirect discrimination, discrimination arising from disability, failure to make reasonable adjustments, unlawful harassment and victimisation.

The Equality Act 2010 provides the principal framework in Great Britain. Where activities or employment fall within Northern Ireland, Spook will apply the relevant Northern Ireland legislation, including protection relating to religious belief and political opinion.

Spook's expectation of respectful treatment extends beyond the minimum legal protections.

05 Recruitment, development and adjustments

Recruitment and employment decisions must be based on relevant skills, experience, performance and legitimate role requirements.

Job descriptions, selection criteria and access to training and progression must be reviewed for unnecessary barriers. Pay and benefits must be determined fairly and consistently.

Spook will consider and implement reasonable adjustments for disabled applicants and workers and meet relevant duties when providing services. Requests will be discussed sensitively, assessed individually and reviewed when circumstances change. Applicants and workers will not be charged for reasonable adjustments.

Health or disability information must be requested only where lawful and necessary and handled confidentially.

06 Preventing harassment

Bullying, sexual harassment and other unlawful harassment are prohibited, including through messages, imagery, jokes, unwanted contact and online behaviour.

Spook will take all reasonable steps to prevent sexual harassment and harassment by third parties. This will include assessing risks, communicating standards, providing proportionate training and responding to warning signs.

Customer or supplier status does not excuse inappropriate conduct. Spook must take proportionate action to protect affected people.

07 Raising and handling concerns

Anyone affected by or witnessing inappropriate behaviour should report it to a director. Reports involving that person should be made to the other director.

A person does not have to confront the individual concerned or attempt informal resolution before making a formal complaint.

Spook will investigate promptly, impartially and as confidentially as practicable.

Those involved will have a fair opportunity to explain their account. An alternative reviewer or external support will be used where necessary to manage conflicts.

Outcomes will be communicated as appropriate, and formal decisions may be appealed to a director who was not involved or an appointed independent reviewer.

Retaliation or victimisation is prohibited.

08 Breaches and review

Breaches may result in disciplinary action, up to and including dismissal following a fair process, or action affecting a third-party relationship.

Directors will review recruitment practices, complaints, adjustments and training needs at least annually. Any equality monitoring will have a lawful purpose, protect personal information and be proportionate to the size of the business.